Fumb: what the A/B test and cohorts tell us

Insights, actions and recommendations

Six numbers that explain the test

$846

gross revenue, 77% from ads

1.4%

of players ever purchase

13.6%

of new players back by day 3

+77%

Variant 2 day-7 retention vs control

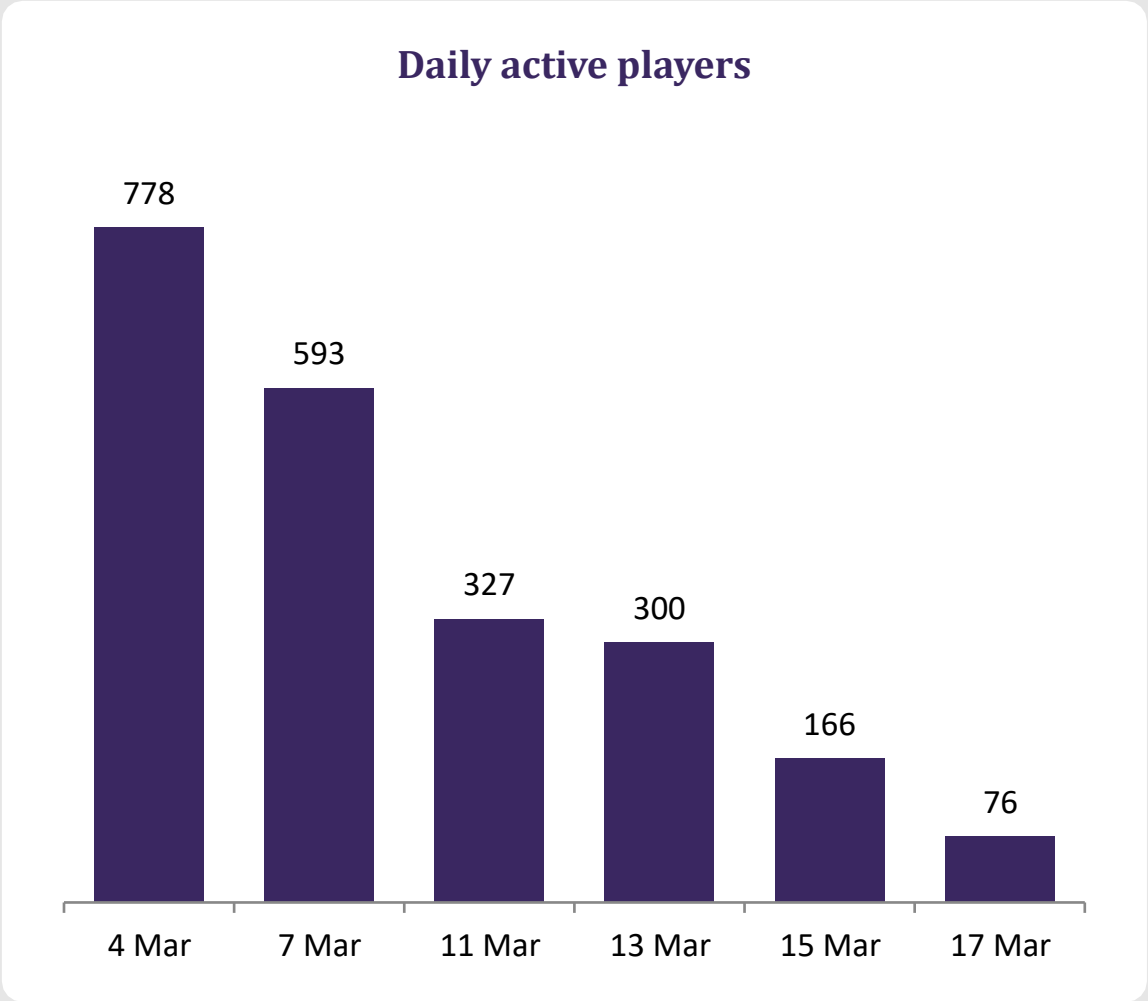
-26%

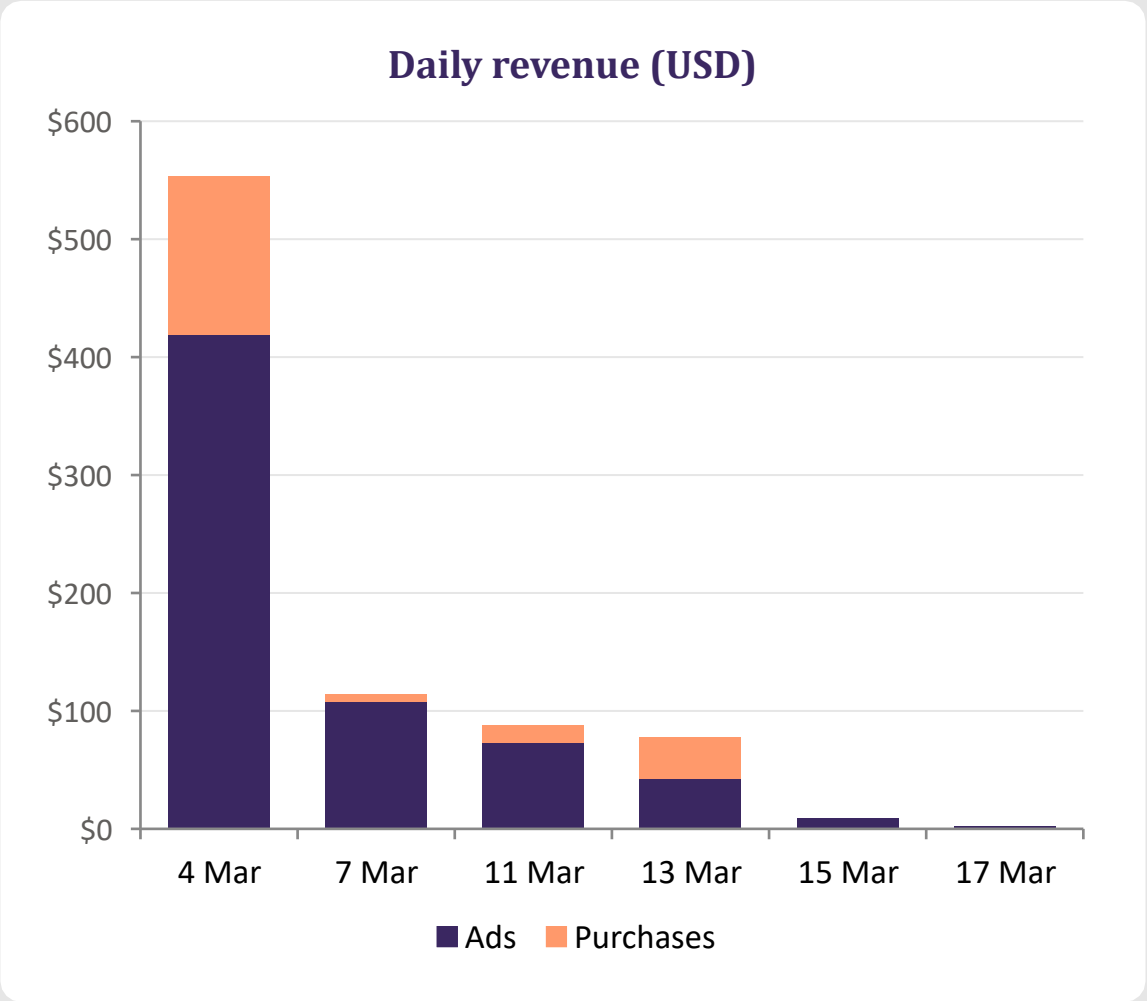
Variant 2 value per ad vs control

29%

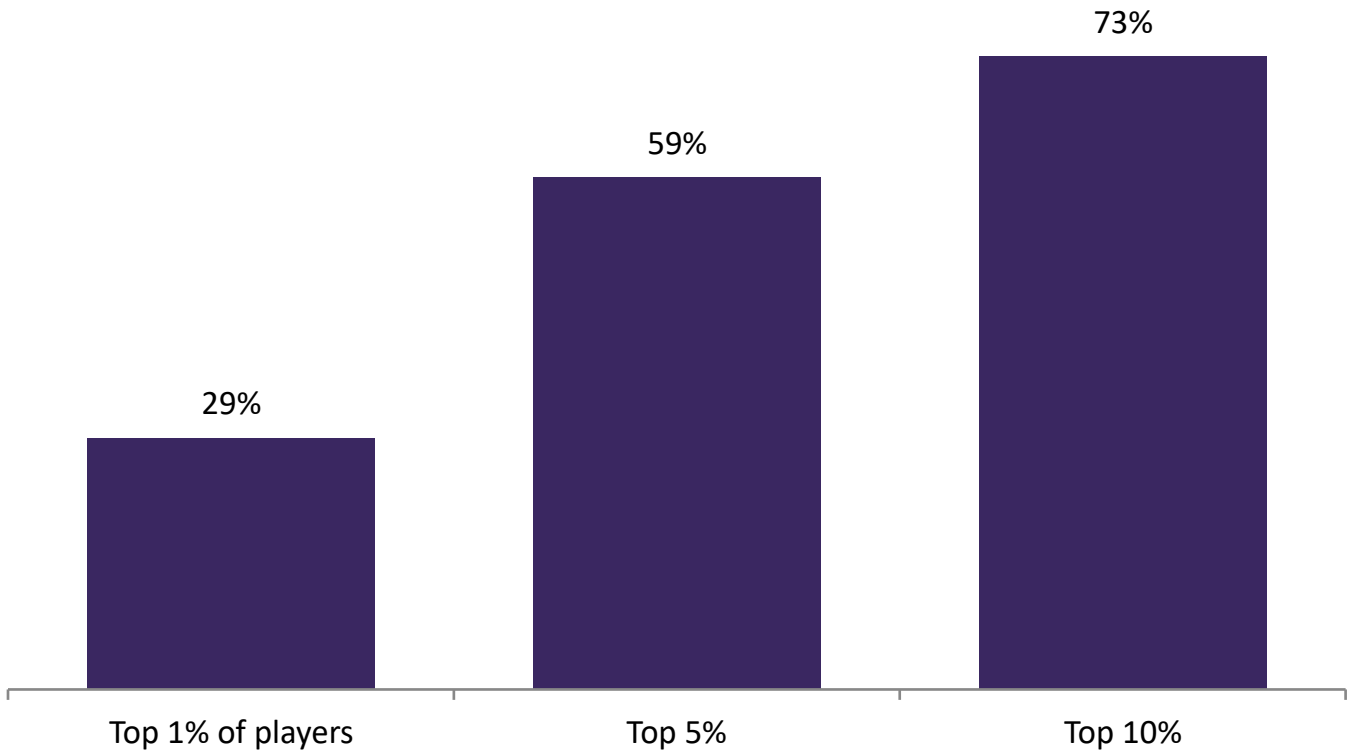
of revenue from the top 1% of players

Launch day carries the business, then it fades fast





A thin tail of players and ads earns most of the money



40%

of players generate no revenue

99.5%

of ad revenue comes from the US

4.6%

of ads (over $0.25) earn 35% of ad revenue

Cohorts that arrive later come back at twice the launch rate

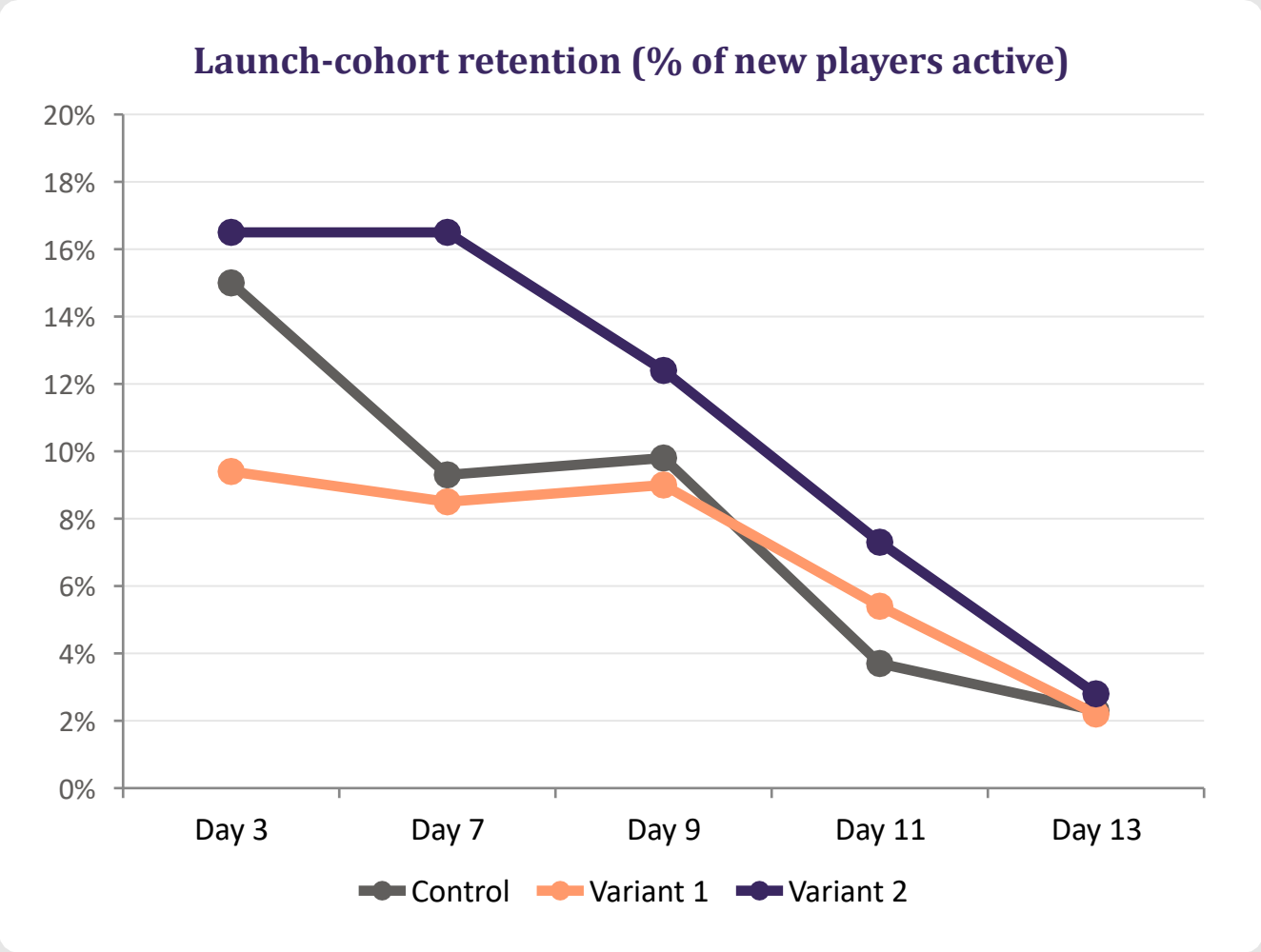
Share of each cohort active on each date

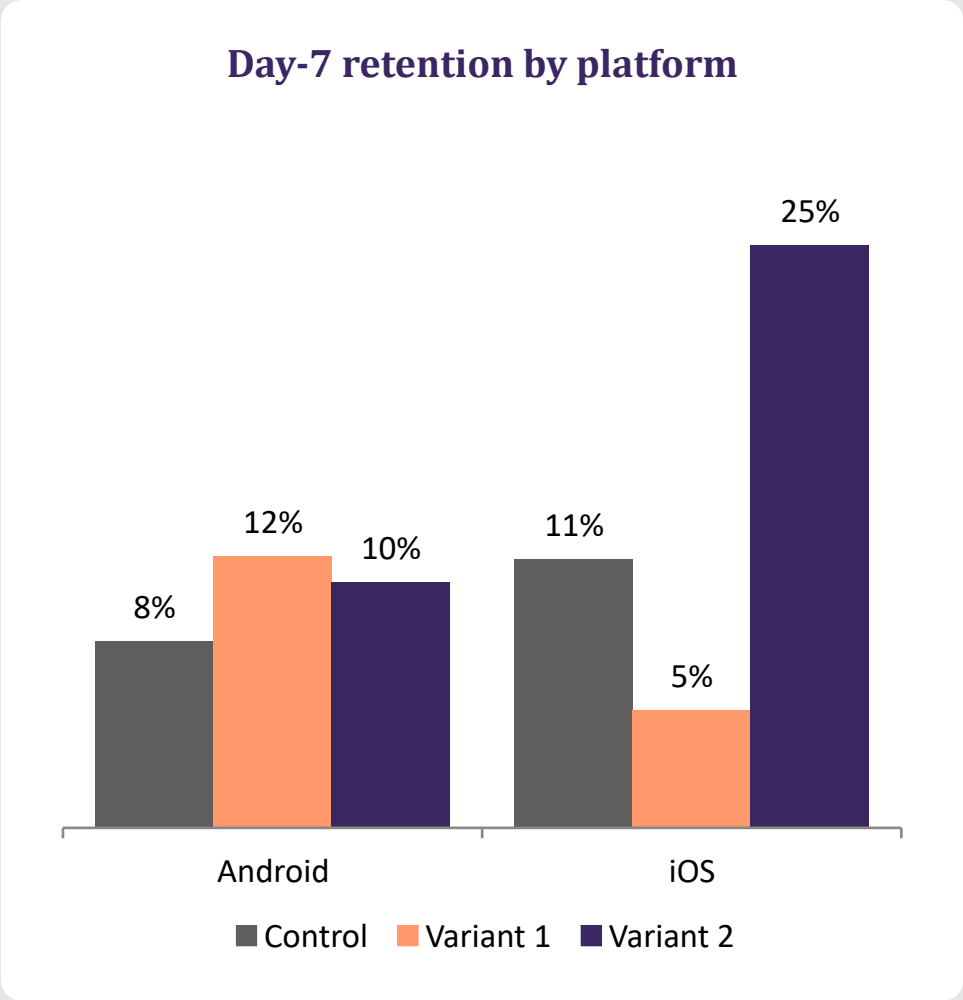
Cohort	4 Mar	7 Mar	11 Mar	13 Mar	15 Mar	17 Mar
4 Mar (n=778)	start	16%	13%	11%	6%	3%
7 Mar (n=467)		start	33%	29%	17%	8%
11 Mar (n=73)			start	38%	19%	6%
13 Mar (n=48)				start	19%	6%
15 Mar (n=18)					start	6%

2x

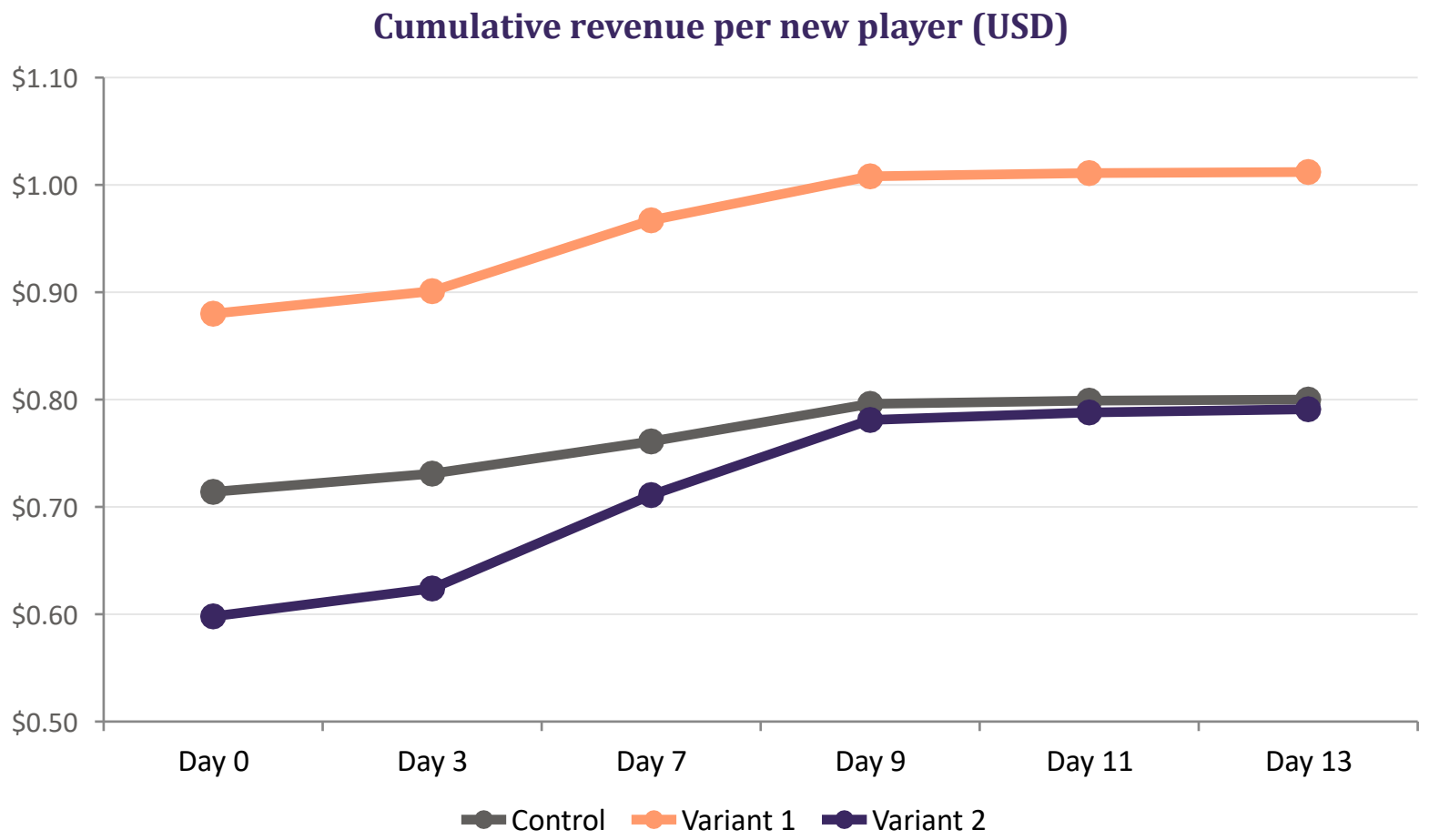
return rate of the 7 Mar cohort (33% four days on) vs launch day (16% at day 3)

Launch cohort: Variant 2 holds players, Variant 1 loses them early





Variant 2 earns less on day 0, then catches up with control by day 13



$0.19

Variant 2 revenue per player after day 0 (control $0.09)

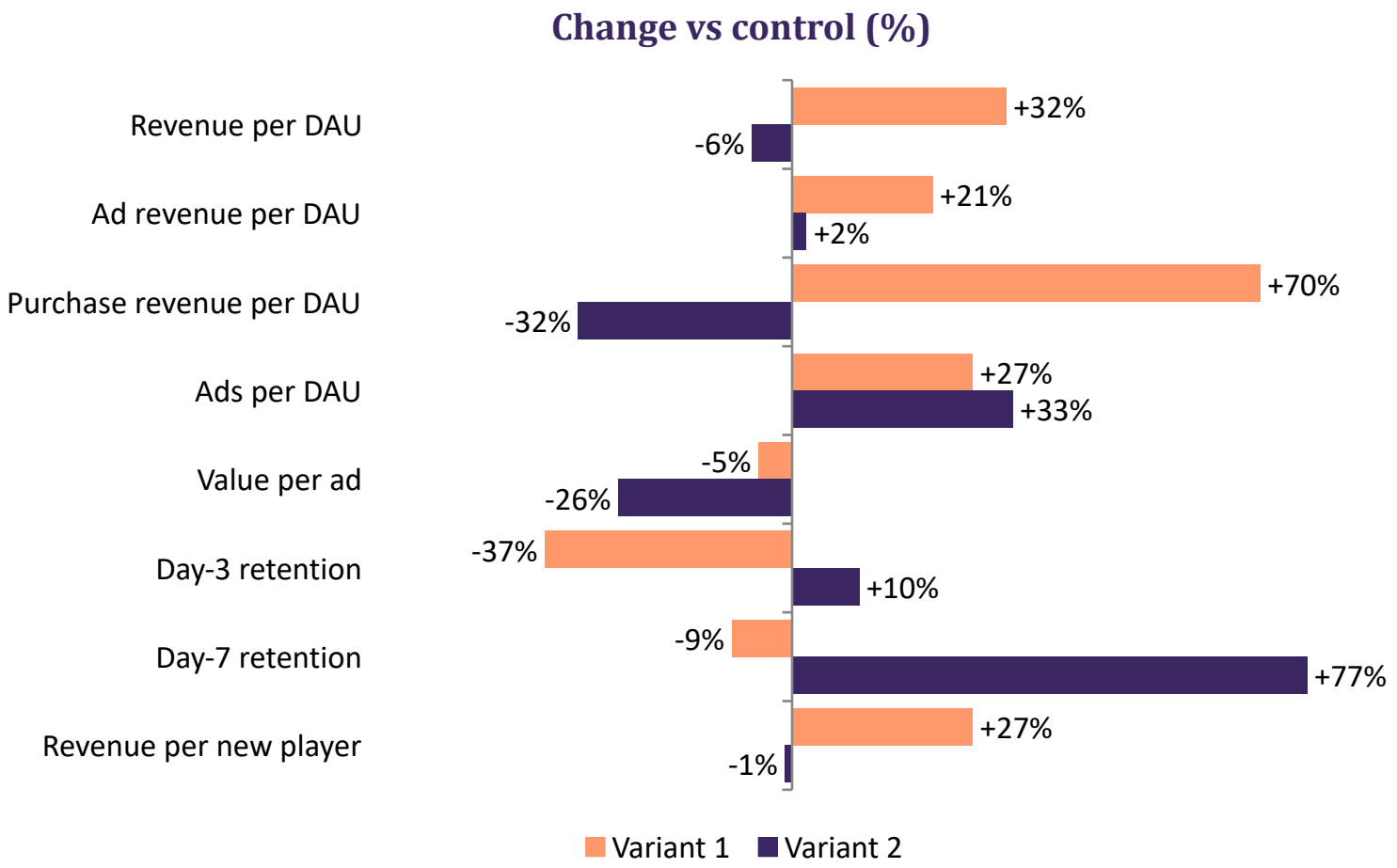
$0.88

Variant 1 revenue on day 0 (control $0.71)

$0.79

Variant 2 total by day 13 vs $0.80 control

Variant 1 monetises, Variant 2 retains, and neither wins outright



Variant 1

Best purchase revenue, weakest day-3 retention

Variant 2

Best retention, ads that earn 26% less

Variant 2 sells more ads at a lower price

+33%

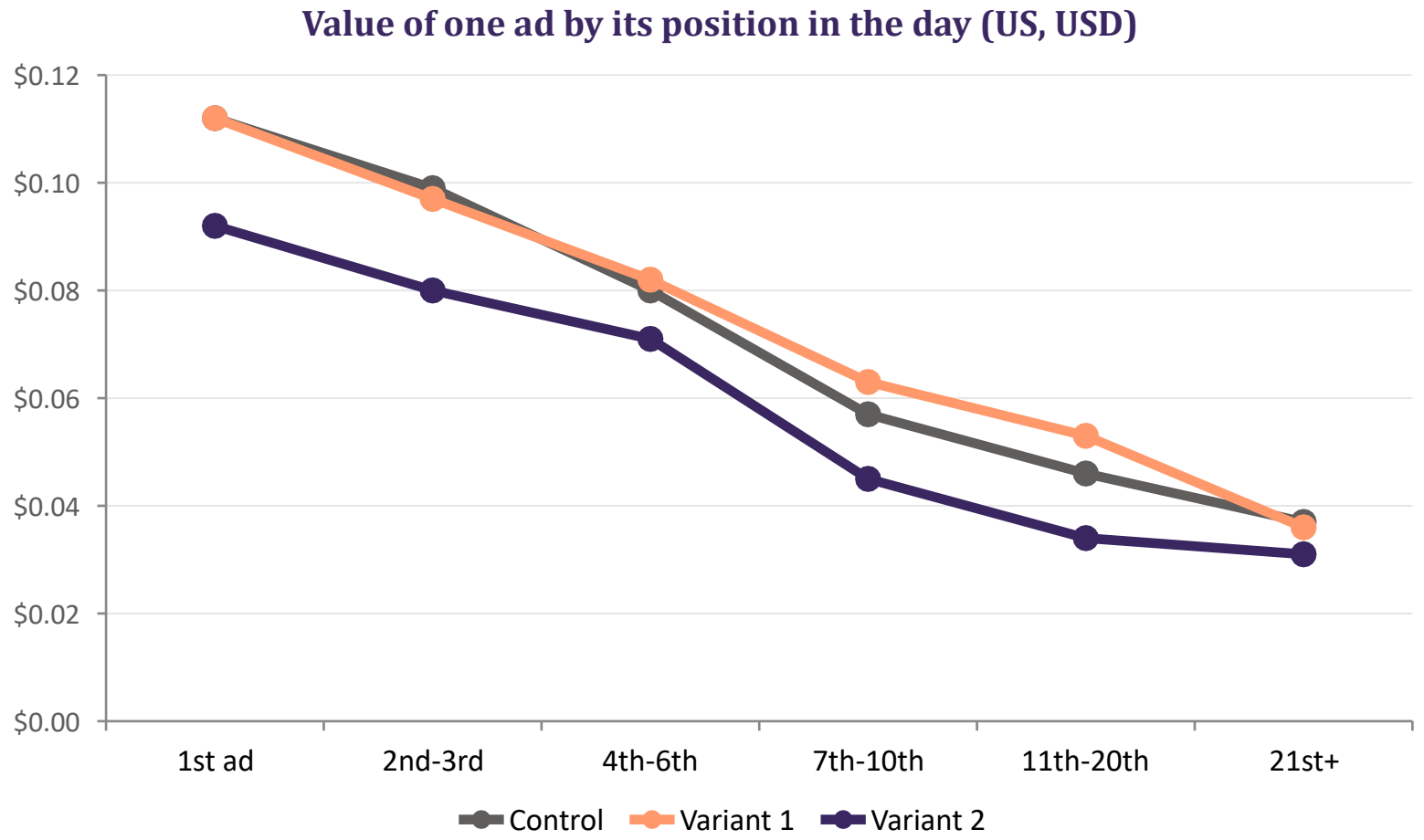
ads per player

-26%

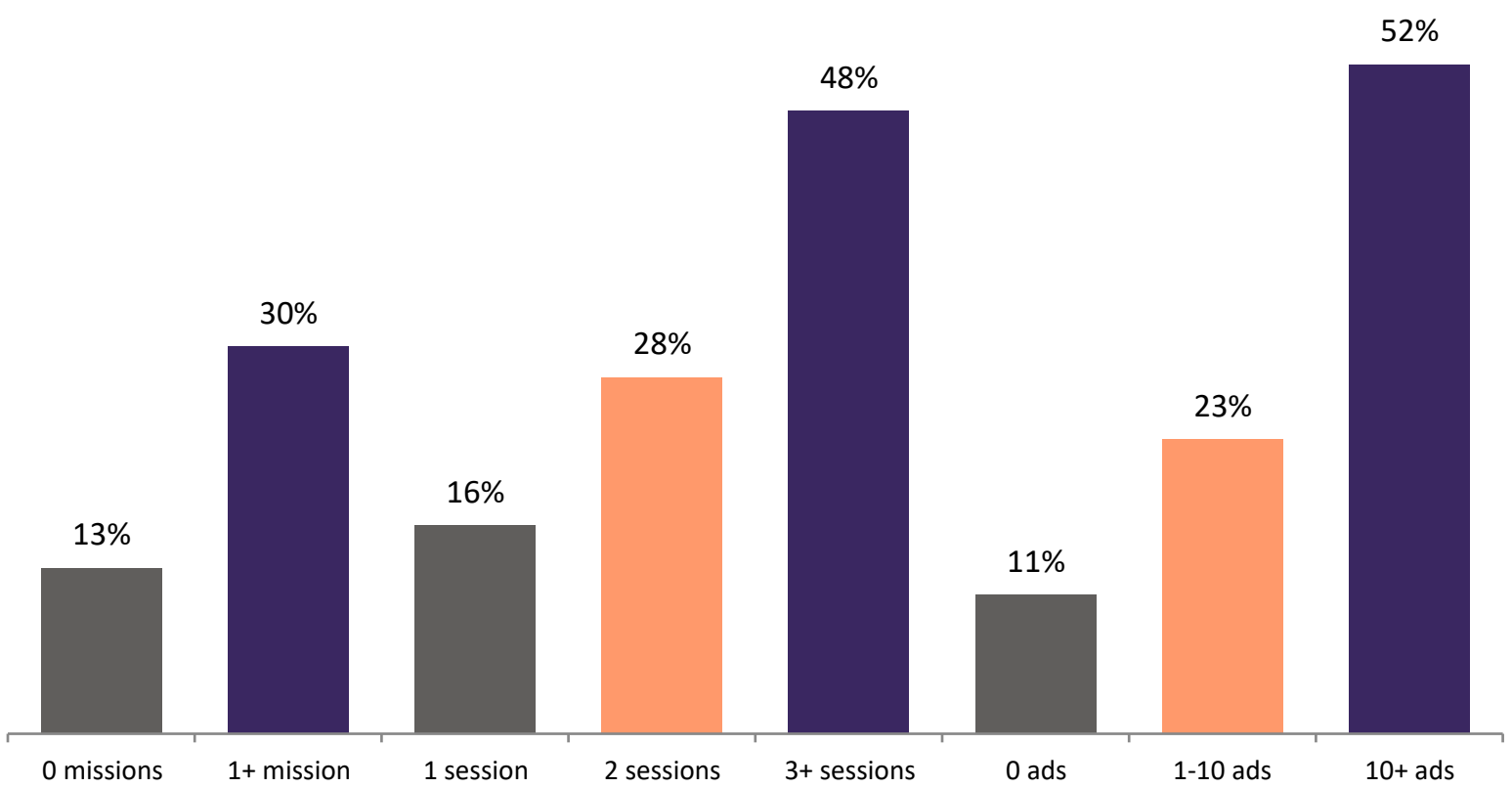
value per ad

+2%

ad revenue per player



Players who engage on day 0 come back 2-5x more often



30% vs 13%

return with vs without a mission

48% vs 16%

return with 3+ sessions vs 1

52%

return among players who watch 10+ ads

Six recommendations

1 Fix Variant 2 ad delivery

Matching control ad value lifts its ad revenue about 33%.

2 Cap daily ads

Ad value falls from $0.11 to $0.03 across a day. Favour rewarded ads.

3 Win day 0

A first mission and a second session lift return 2-3x.

4 Blend the variants

Variant 1 buyers pay $15 vs $9. Variant 2 keeps players.

5 Focus UA on the US

US earns $0.39 per player-day, the rest of world $0.03.

6 Re-test at scale

Need about 5,500 players per arm to read purchase lift.

Action plan: diagnose, build, re-test

Weeks 1-2 | Diagnose

- Audit Variant 2 ad placement and mediation
- Log first_open and every day of events

Weeks 3-4 | Build

- Day-0 mission and second-session flow
- Daily ad cap with rewarded ads

Month 2 | Re-test

- Three arms, 5,500+ players each
- Ship if D7 up 3 points and ARPDAU holds